Riju Garg

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Education

Madras School of Economics
M.A. General Economics 2023 - 2025

- GPA: 8.0/10
- Courses: Applied Econometrics, Intermediate Macroeconomics , International Trade, Mathematical Statistics, Development Economics, Public Economics, Game Theory
- Thesis: *Examining Total Factor Productivity in India's Unincorporated Manufacturing Enterprises: Stylized Facts and Determinants*
  Carried out unit-level extraction process from ASUSE 2022-23 to find total factor productivity (TFP) using VAKL model and analyzed the impact of self-reported operational problems such as demand shrinkage, credit issues and 20 other indicators on productivity, under Dr Gopal Krishna Roy.

Maitreyi College, University of Delhi
B.A. (H) Economics 2020 - 2023

- GPA: 8.527/10
- Courses: Macroeconomics, Money and Financial Markets, Law and Economics, Data Analysis, Mathematical Methods for Economics

Work Experience

Reserve Bank of India | Mumbai 2026/01 - Present

- Research Intern at Division of Local Finances, Department of Economic and Policy Research (DEPR).
- Analysed ASUSE 2023–24 data on rural unincorporated enterprises, linking it with district-level developmental expenditure, PMGSY expenditure, and MGNREGA wages to examine the relationship between public spending and firm performance; constructed a district-level panel using ASUSE data from 2022 to 2025.
- Contributed to the Division Report on Panchayat Finances through data visualisation and proofreading, and developed a dataset covering 200+ municipal websites using 48 indicators informed by the UN's Local Online Service Index (LOSI).
- Cleaned and processed macroeconomic and administrative datasets, including rainfall, Gross State Value Added (GSVA), inflation, and Basic Statistical Returns (BSR) credit data.

Nation First Policy Research & Change Foundation | Noida 2025/08 - 2025/12

- Public Policy Consultant, Centre for Accelerating India's Growth.
- Delivered evidence-based policy analysis and impact evaluations for major government programmes (e.g., Jal Jeevan Mission), leading survey design, fieldwork, stakeholder consultations, econometric analysis, and policy briefs to inform implementation and reform.
- Final report of the Jal Jeevan Mission evaluation published with official recognition from the Ministry of Jal Shakti, Government of India.

Research Interests

Informal Economy, Economic Growth, Sustainability, Industrial Productivity, Development Economics, Applied Econometrics, Labour Economics

Policy Report

1. **Sriram, M., Garg, R., Choudhary, S., et al.** *Strengthening the Rural Water Service Paradigm: A Policy Evaluation of Jal Jeevan Mission and Pathways for Sustainable Delivery*. Centre for Accelerating India's Growth, NFPRC Foundation. 2026.

   Policy evaluation of the Jal Jeevan Mission using primary survey data from 3,065 households across 12 districts in six states. Examines programme implementation, service reliability, tap functionality, water quality, and household welfare outcomes, with recommendations for strengthening source sustainability, operations and maintenance financing, local governance, and long-term rural water service delivery.

Working Papers

1. **Garg, R., Sankaran, S.** *Beyond the Formal Grid: The Role of Fiscal Expenditure on Rural Unorganised Firm Performance*. 2026.

   Examines the relationship between district-level road infrastructure expenditure under PMGSY and the performance of rural unincorporated proprietary enterprises across 21 Indian states, using ASUSE 2023–24 microdata and district-level indicators.

2. **Garg, R., Sarma, R.** *The Himalayan Tightrope: Balancing Growth and Sustainability in an Ecologically- Sensitive Ecosystem*. 2025.

   The study uses high-resolution town- and village-level satellite data to examine the relationship between infrastructure development, environmental sustainability, and growth in the ecologically sensitive Himalayan biome. It builds a novel two-decade dataset covering five economic and environmental indicators and finds significant spatial and temporal heterogeneity, with implications for sustainable development and decentralized policy-making.

Conferences

67th Conference of the Indian Society of Labour Economics (ISLE)
Banaras Hindu University 2026/12

59th Conference of the Indian Econometric Society
Banaras Hindu University 2025/03

Kautilya Colloquy
Kautilya School of Public Policy 2024/09

Avlokan 2022
Maitreyi College 2022/09

Equinox: The Annual International Conference
Maitreyi College 2022/08

Awards

- **Best Paper**, Kautilya Colloquy, Kautilya School of Public Policy 2024/09
- **All Rounder Achiever Award**, Economics Department, Maitreyi College 2023/06

Skills

Stata: unit-level data extraction, advanced econometrics, visualizations

G-Suite: forms, sheets, documentation

MS Office: documentation and presentations; Excel functions

R: data manipulation, visualization

Git: repository management

LaTeX: documentation, presentations

QGIS: geospatial analysis and visualization

Python: data analysis

Referees

Dr. Gopal Krishna Roy
Assistant Professor
Madras School of Economics
Chennai, TN
Email: gopal.roy@mse.ac.in

Ms. Subhadhra Sankaran
Deputy General Manager, DEPR
Reserve Bank of India
Mumbai, MH
Email: subhadhras@rbi.org.in

Interests and Activities

- **Editor**, Economics Departmental Magazine, Maitreyi College 2022-23
- **Secretary**, Economics Association, Maitreyi College 2021-22
- **Graphic Designer**, Achievement Cell, University of Delhi 2021-22
- **Member**, Abhivyakti- Theatre Society, Maitreyi College 2020-21